

GDPR Documentation — AI Career LaunchPad

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Project: AI Career LaunchPad

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Context: Ironhack AI Consulting & Integration Bootcamp — Final Capstone Project

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1. Overview — Three Use Cases, Three Compliance Postures

AI Career LaunchPad operates across three distinct use cases, each with a different GDPR role structure. The compliance obligations differ materially between them.

<i>Use Case</i>	<i>LaunchPad Role</i>	<i>Operator Role</i>	<i>Primary Compliance Burden</i>
<i>UC1 — Integrated into training provider portal</i>	<i>Data Processor</i>	<i>Training provider is Data Controller</i>	<i>Training provider. LaunchPad acts under DPA.</i>
<i>UC2 — Individual use via coaching practice</i>	<i>Data Controller</i>	<i>Marco Martins (coach and operator)</i>	<i>LaunchPad / Marco Martins. Full GDPR obligations apply.</i>
<i>UC3 — Licensed to career transition coaches</i>	<i>Data Processor</i>	<i>Licensed coach is Data Controller</i>	<i>Licensed coach. LaunchPad acts under DPA template.</i>

The detailed GDPR documentation in this file applies primarily to Use Case 2, where LaunchPad is the data controller. Use Cases 1 and 3 are governed by contractual arrangements (Data Processing Agreements) described in Section 6.

2. Data Flow Map

What personal data the system collects and processes

<i>Data Type</i>	<i>Source</i>	<i>Special Category?</i>	<i>Flows to</i>
<i>LinkedIn profile PDF</i>	<i>Uploaded by user at form trigger</i>	<i>No — professional/career data</i>	<i>n8n (processing), OpenAI API (LLM extraction)</i>
<i>CliftonStrengths report PDF</i>	<i>Uploaded by user at form trigger</i>	<i>Potentially yes — psychometric/personality data</i>	<i>n8n (processing), OpenAI API (LLM extraction)</i>
<i>Self-Reflection Workbook PDF</i>	<i>Uploaded by user at form trigger</i>	<i>Potentially yes — contains psychological profile data (career anxieties, identity, concerns)</i>	<i>n8n (processing), OpenAI API (LLM extraction)</i>
<i>Job Description PDF (WF3)</i>	<i>Uploaded by user at form trigger</i>	<i>No — third-party document, no personal data about the user</i>	<i>n8n (processing), OpenAI API (LLM extraction)</i>
<i>Career Compass JSON export</i>	<i>Generated by WF1, downloaded by user, re-uploaded to WF3</i>	<i>Yes — structured personal profile data</i>	<i>n8n (processing), OpenAI API (LLM analysis)</i>

<i>Data Type</i>	<i>Source</i>	<i>Special Category?</i>	<i>Flows to</i>
<i>IP address / session metadata</i>	<i>Collected by n8n Cloud on form submission</i>	<i>No</i>	<i>n8n Cloud infrastructure (EU)</i>

Data flow diagram

User

|

| — Uploads PDFs via n8n Form Trigger

| └─ n8n Cloud (EU) — processes binary files, extracts text

| └─ OpenAI API (US) — LLM extraction and generation

| └─ Response returned to n8n

| └─ HTML report returned to user browser

|

└─ No data stored beyond session (POC)

MVP: structured outputs stored in Supabase (EU region)

Key data flow principles

- *At POC stage, no candidate data is stored beyond the active session. When the browser closes, the data is gone.*
 - *Data passes through OpenAI's API servers (United States) during LLM processing. This constitutes an international data transfer under GDPR Chapter V.*
 - *n8n Cloud infrastructure is hosted in the EU. Binary file processing and code execution occur within the EU.*
 - *The Career Compass JSON export is downloaded to the user's own device. At that point it is under the user's control, not LaunchPad's.*
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3. Processing Activities Register

Activity 1 — Career profile extraction and analysis (WF1)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data processed</i>	<i>LinkedIn profile PDF, CliftonStrengths report PDF, Self-Reflection Workbook PDF</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>Extract structured career portrait, score against 8 AI consulting archetypes, generate personalised Career Compass report</i>
<i>Legal basis — standard data</i>	<i>Article 6(1)(b) — Contract performance. The user submits data specifically to receive the Career Compass report. Processing is necessary to deliver the service.</i>
<i>Legal basis — special category data</i>	<i>Article 9(2)(a) — Explicit consent. CliftonStrengths and self-reflection data may constitute psychometric or psychological profile data under Article 9. Explicit consent obtained via checkbox at form trigger before upload.</i>
<i>Retention period</i>	<i>Session only (POC). 90 days from submission (MVP) — covers a typical job search cycle. Deleted automatically after 90 days.</i>
<i>Third-party recipients</i>	<i>OpenAI (data processor, US — see Section 5). n8n Cloud (infrastructure processor, EU).</i>
<i>Data subjects</i>	<i>Individual professionals using the service directly (UC2).</i>

Activity 2 — Job fit analysis and application generation (WF3)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data processed</i>	<i>Career Compass JSON export (structured personal profile), Job Description PDF (third-party document)</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>Score fit between candidate profile and specific job, generate cover letter and interview preparation</i>
<i>Legal basis — standard data</i>	<i>Article 6(1)(b) — Contract performance.</i>
<i>Legal basis — special category data</i>	<i>Article 9(2)(a) — Explicit consent. Career Compass JSON contains psychometric data derived from CliftonStrengths. Consent already obtained at WF1 stage. Re-confirmed at WF3 form trigger.</i>
<i>Retention period</i>	<i>Session only (POC). 90 days from submission (MVP).</i>
<i>Third-party recipients</i>	<i>OpenAI (data processor, US). n8n Cloud (infrastructure processor, EU).</i>
<i>Data subjects</i>	<i>Individual professionals using the service directly (UC2).</i>

Activity 3 — User satisfaction data collection (MVP)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data processed</i>	<i>Satisfaction rating (1–5), optional free-text comment, submission timestamp</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>Measure output quality, identify improvement areas, validate success criteria</i>
<i>Legal basis</i>	<i>Article 6(1)(f) — Legitimate interest. Collecting feedback on AI-generated outputs is a proportionate interest in improving service quality. Balancing test: low intrusion (optional, anonymisable), clear benefit, no overriding user interest against.</i>
<i>Retention period</i>	<i>12 months. Aggregated and anonymised after 12 months.</i>
<i>Third-party recipients</i>	<i>Supabase (database processor, EU region — MVP).</i>
<i>Data subjects</i>	<i>Individual users who choose to submit feedback.</i>

Activity 4 — Coach onboarding data (UC3 — MVP)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data processed</i>	<i>Coach name, email, business name, country, payment data</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>Manage licensing agreements, access control, invoicing</i>
<i>Legal basis</i>	<i>Article 6(1)(b) — Contract performance.</i>
<i>Retention period</i>	<i>Duration of licence agreement + 7 years (tax and legal obligation).</i>
<i>Third-party recipients</i>	<i>Payment processor (Stripe or equivalent, EU/US).</i>
<i>Data subjects</i>	<i>Licensed career transition coaches (UC3).</i>

4. Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA)

Processing activity assessed: Career profile extraction and analysis (Activity 1 — WF1)

This activity is selected for DPIA because it involves the highest concentration of personal data, including potentially special category psychometric data, processed through a third-country transfer to OpenAI.

Description of the Processing

The user uploads three PDF documents: their LinkedIn profile, their CliftonStrengths report, and a completed Self-Reflection Workbook. The n8n workflow extracts text from all three documents, splits the content into structured inputs, and passes them to OpenAI's gpt-4o model via API. Seven sequential and parallel LLM calls extract a structured candidate portrait, score the portrait against 8 career archetypes, and generate a personalised Career Compass report. The report is returned to the user as an HTML page. No data is stored beyond the session at POC stage.

Necessity and Proportionality Assessment

Is the processing necessary? Yes. The Career Compass report cannot be produced without processing the three input documents. The structured extraction of career history, strengths, and self-reflection answers is the core technical mechanism of the service. There is no less privacy-intrusive way to deliver the same output.

Is the processing proportionate? The data processed is limited to what the user voluntarily submits. The system does not collect data beyond the three uploaded documents. It does not infer additional data, enrich profiles from external sources, or build longitudinal profiles. The output is returned directly to the user and not shared with third parties. The proportionality assessment is favourable.

Could less data achieve the same purpose? Partially. The LinkedIn profile could theoretically be replaced by a structured form — but this would degrade output quality significantly, as LinkedIn PDF extraction captures richer career context than a form can. The CliftonStrengths report is required for the strengths layer and cannot be substituted. The self-reflection workbook could be shortened — this is a product decision, not a compliance requirement.

Risks to Data Subjects

<i>Risk</i>	<i>Likelihood</i>	<i>Severity</i>	<i>Risk Level</i>
<i>Unauthorised access to personal data during transmission to OpenAI</i>	<i>Low — HTTPS in transit</i>	<i>High — contains sensitive career and psychometric data</i>	<i>Medium</i>
<i>OpenAI retains and uses submitted data to train future models</i>	<i>Low — OpenAI API data is not used for training by default under current terms</i>	<i>High — psychometric data should not be used for model training</i>	<i>Medium</i>
<i>Inaccurate AI output causes candidate to misprice themselves or target wrong roles</i>	<i>Medium — output quality depends on input quality and model performance</i>	<i>Medium — financial and career impact, but user retains full agency</i>	<i>Medium</i>
<i>Data breach at n8n Cloud infrastructure level</i>	<i>Low — EU-hosted, credential-based access</i>	<i>High — full candidate profile exposed</i>	<i>Medium</i>
<i>User downloads Career Compass JSON and loses control of their own data</i>	<i>Medium — user downloads to their own device</i>	<i>Low — user is the data subject and controls their own device</i>	<i>Low</i>
<i>Special category data (psychometric) processed without adequate legal basis</i>	<i>Low if consent mechanism implemented</i>	<i>High — regulatory risk, potential fine</i>	<i>Medium (mitigated by consent)</i>

Mitigation Measures

<i>Risk</i>	<i>Mitigation</i>
<i>Transmission security</i>	<i>HTTPS enforced on all n8n webhook endpoints. OpenAI API called over HTTPS.</i>
<i>OpenAI data retention</i>	<i>Data Processing Agreement with OpenAI in place (OpenAI's standard API DPA). API data is not used for model training under current terms. Review OpenAI DPA at each major terms update.</i>
<i>Output inaccuracy</i>	<i>Mandatory gap analysis on all profile matches. Transparency notices on all output pages. Explicit instruction not to act on outputs without personal review. Human oversight layer in coaching model.</i>
<i>Infrastructure breach</i>	<i>n8n Cloud EU hosting. Credential-based API key storage. No candidate data stored beyond session at POC. MVP: implement access controls and audit logging before enabling data persistence.</i>
<i>Special category legal basis</i>	<i>Explicit consent checkbox at form trigger before any document upload. Consent records stored separately. Consent can be withdrawn — data deleted on request.</i>

Residual Risk Rating

After mitigation measures are applied: Low to Medium overall.

The primary residual risk is the OpenAI third-country transfer — even with a DPA in place, data physically transits US infrastructure. This is a structural characteristic of using any major LLM API provider and is shared by the vast majority of AI applications operating in Europe today. It is mitigated but not eliminated by the Standard Contractual Clauses mechanism (see Section 5).

A secondary residual risk is output accuracy — the system cannot guarantee that its career profile matching is correct for every candidate. This is mitigated by design (mandatory gaps, advisory framing, transparency notices) but cannot be eliminated entirely. It is not a GDPR risk per se, but it is an ethical risk that the system takes seriously (see eu_ai_act_compliance.md, Section 4).

5. Data Subject Rights

Under GDPR Articles 15-22, data subjects have the following rights. This section describes how AI Career LaunchPad supports each right in Use Case 2 (LaunchPad as controller).

Right of Access (Article 15)

How supported: At POC stage, no data is stored — access requests are trivially satisfied (no data held). At MVP stage, users can request a copy of all data held about them via email to the data controller. Response within 30 days. Data provided in a machine-readable format (JSON).

Right to Erasure (Article 17)

How supported: At POC stage, session-only storage means data is deleted automatically when the session ends. At MVP stage, users can request deletion of all stored data via email. Data deleted within 7 days of verified request. Deletion confirmed in writing.

Right to Rectification (Article 16)

How supported: The system processes user-supplied documents. If a user believes their extracted data is inaccurate, they may resubmit corrected documents. At MVP stage, stored structured data can be corrected on request.

Right to Data Portability (Article 20)

How supported: The Career Compass JSON export (available in Tab 5 of the report) is the portability mechanism — the user's structured profile data is available for download in machine-readable JSON format at the point of use. At MVP stage, stored data available on request in JSON format.

Right to Object (Article 21)

How supported: Users may object to processing at any time by not submitting data or by requesting deletion of submitted data. Where processing is based on legitimate interest

(satisfaction data, Activity 3), users may object and processing will cease for that individual.

Right not to be subject to solely automated decision-making (Article 22)

How supported: No output from AI Career LaunchPad constitutes a solely automated decision with legal or similarly significant effect. All outputs are advisory. The user retains full agency over whether and how to act on them. No automated decision is made about the user — the system produces inputs to a human decision process. This right is not engaged, but the system is designed to respect its spirit in all cases.

6. Third-Party Data Transfers

OpenAI (Primary LLM Provider)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data sent</i>	<i>Extracted text from LinkedIn PDF, CliftonStrengths PDF, Self-Reflection Workbook PDF, structured candidate portrait JSON, job description text</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>LLM-based extraction, analysis, and generation</i>
<i>Legal mechanism</i>	<i>Standard Contractual Clauses (SCCs) — incorporated into OpenAI's Data Processing Addendum for API customers</i>
<i>Data storage location</i>	<i>United States (OpenAI infrastructure)</i>

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Retention by OpenAI</i>	<i>API inputs and outputs are not retained for training purposes under OpenAI's current API terms. Data may be retained for up to 30 days for abuse monitoring, then deleted.</i>
<i>Risk assessment</i>	<i>Medium. US transfer is a structural dependency of using OpenAI's API. SCCs provide the legal mechanism but do not eliminate the transfer risk. Monitor for EU AI Act and GDPR enforcement developments regarding US LLM providers.</i>
<i>DPA reference</i>	<i>OpenAI Data Processing Addendum — available at openai.com/policies/data-processing-addendum</i>

n8n Cloud (Workflow Infrastructure)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data sent</i>	<i>All data processed by the workflow — PDFs, extracted text, LLM outputs, generated HTML</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>Workflow execution, binary file handling, webhook processing</i>
<i>Legal mechanism</i>	<i>Within EU — no international transfer. n8n Cloud EU region. Standard data processing relationship.</i>
<i>Data storage location</i>	<i>European Union</i>

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Retention by n8n</i>	<i>Execution logs retained per n8n Cloud plan settings. At POC: execution data retained for 7 days. Configure to minimum retention at MVP.</i>
<i>Risk assessment</i>	<i>Low. EU-hosted infrastructure. No transfer outside EEA.</i>
<i>DPA reference</i>	<i>n8n Cloud Data Processing Agreement — available at n8n.io/legal</i>

Supabase (MVP Database — Planned)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Data sent</i>	<i>Structured Career Compass outputs, satisfaction ratings, user identifiers (MVP)</i>
<i>Purpose</i>	<i>Data persistence, satisfaction tracking, audit logging</i>
<i>Legal mechanism</i>	<i>EU region deployment. Within EU — no international transfer if EU region selected at project creation.</i>
<i>Data storage location</i>	<i>European Union (must be configured explicitly at project setup — default may be US)</i>

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Retention by Supabase</i>	<i>Controlled by LaunchPad configuration. 90-day retention policy applied at application level.</i>
<i>Risk assessment</i>	<i>Low if EU region configured correctly. Medium if default US region used in error — configuration must be verified before MVP deployment.</i>
<i>DPA reference</i>	<i>Supabase Data Processing Agreement — available at supabase.com/privacy</i>

Ironhack / Training Provider (UC1 — Controller relationship)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Relationship</i>	<i>Training provider is the data controller. LaunchPad is the data processor.</i>
<i>Legal mechanism</i>	<i>Data Processing Agreement signed between training provider and LaunchPad before any student data is processed. DPA must cover: processing purpose, data types, retention, sub-processors (OpenAI, n8n), security measures, deletion on contract termination.</i>
<i>Data sent to LaunchPad</i>	<i>Student LinkedIn PDFs, CliftonStrengths reports, self-reflection workbooks — submitted via training provider-branded form.</i>

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>LaunchPad obligations</i>	<i>Process only as instructed by controller. Do not use student data for any purpose beyond the Career Compass service. Delete all data on contract termination or on controller's instruction. Support controller in responding to data subject requests. Notify controller of any data breach within 72 hours.</i>
<i>Student rights</i>	<i>Managed by the training provider as controller. LaunchPad supports the controller in fulfilling requests but does not interact directly with students on data rights matters in this use case.</i>

Licensed Career Transition Coaches (UC3 — Controller relationship)

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Relationship</i>	<i>Licensed coach is the data controller for their clients. LaunchPad is the data processor.</i>
<i>Legal mechanism</i>	<i>Standard Data Processing Agreement included in the coach licensing agreement. Coaches must sign before receiving API access or form URLs.</i>
<i>LaunchPad obligations</i>	<i>Same as UC1. Process only as instructed. No use of client data beyond the service. Delete on request. Breach notification within 72 hours.</i>

<i>Field</i>	<i>Detail</i>
<i>Coach obligations (contractual)</i>	<i>Coach must have a lawful basis for processing their clients' data. Coach must obtain appropriate consent from clients before submitting their data to LaunchPad. Coach is responsible for their own privacy notice covering LaunchPad as a sub-processor.</i>
<i>DPA template</i>	<i>Standard DPA template to be drafted before UC3 launch. Must be reviewed by a data protection specialist.</i>

7. Data Processing Agreement Templates — Status

<i>Agreement</i>	<i>Required for</i>	<i>Status</i>
<i>DPA with OpenAI</i>	<i>All use cases</i>	<i>Exists — OpenAI standard API DPA</i>
<i>DPA with n8n Cloud</i>	<i>All use cases</i>	<i>Exists — n8n standard cloud DPA</i>
<i>DPA with Supabase</i>	<i>MVP (UC2, UC3)</i>	<i>Planned — required before MVP data persistence enabled</i>
<i>DPA template for training providers</i>	<i>UC1</i>	<i>Planned — required before first operator licence signed</i>
<i>DPA template for licensed coaches</i>	<i>UC3</i>	<i>Planned — required before first coach licence signed</i>

<i>Agreement</i>	<i>Required for</i>	<i>Status</i>
<i>Privacy Notice for individual users</i>	<i>UC2</i>	<i>Planned — required before MVP launch</i>
<i>Consent mechanism at form trigger</i>	<i>UC2</i>	<i>Planned — Sprint 1 (also required for EU AI Act — see eu_ai_act_compliance.md)</i>

*AI Career LaunchPad — Ironhack AI Consulting & Integration Bootcamp — Week 9
Capstone*